



1895–1945

The atomic age

An era that experienced two devastating world wars also witnessed the arrival of aircraft, radio, and television, and saw cars and many electrical appliances become everyday items. The period began with the discovery of radioactivity and led to a better understanding of what lies inside atoms, including their vast energy potential. At the other end of the scale, major advances were made in our understanding of the Universe, and how it formed and developed, while astronomers proved that our galaxy was not alone, but one of billions in space.